

Θεόφραστος ὁ Ἐρέσιος

Iambic Verse and Philosophy in Theophrastus of Eresus

eul_aid: lmw

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Φιλοσοφική Ἀττική [Attic Philosophical](#)
Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Theophrastus of Eresus was a Greek philosopher and scientist of the early Hellenistic period, active from approximately 371 to 287 BCE. A native of Lesbos, he studied in Athens under Plato and later under Aristotle. He became Aristotle's closest associate and succeeded him as head of the Peripatetic school, the Lyceum, which he led for about thirty-five years.

An extraordinarily prolific writer, Theophrastus produced hundreds of works on logic, ethics, metaphysics, and natural science, though only a few survive. His most famous works are two long botanical treatises, **Enquiry into Plants** and **On the Causes of Plants**. These works systematically describe and classify hundreds of plant species, their physiology, and their uses, forming the foundation of botany in the Western tradition.

Another well-known surviving work is **Characters**, a series of short, sharp sketches of negative personality types that influenced later satire. Modern scholars view Theophrastus as crucial for preserving and critically developing Aristotle's ideas, thereby ensuring the survival of the Peripatetic school. His historical significance rests on his role as Aristotle's successor and, above all, on his pioneering empirical study of the plant world, which remained authoritative for over a thousand years.

Works (1)

- [Χαρακτήρες](#) · Theophrastus the Philosopher-the Divine Art in Iambic Verses · 17 passages